

Prayers for our World and the Church

24th May 2026

Psalm 33:20-22

20 We wait in hope for the Lord; He is our help and our shield.

21 In Him our hearts rejoice, for we trust in His holy Name.

22 May Your unfailing love be with us, Lord, even as we put our hope in You.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that You are our help and our shield whether the times are calm or in turmoil. We rejoice in Your unfailing love towards us and all Your people.

We thank You for sending Jesus, to be our Perfect Saviour, our substitute. We thank You that we have been completely forgiven, and have been set free from the penalty, the power and the guilt of our sinful past. Because Jesus lives and reigns, we have a sure hope for the future.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We thank You for Your church, the Body of Christ, where we find fellowship, love and support. We thank You that it is the guardian of the Truth we find in Your Precious Word, so we can draw from saints of old and saints still with us. We thank You for their wisdom, and their examples of how to live in the world today. We pray for Your guidance to apply what they teach us, so that we can know You better, and grow in grace daily.

We pray for this world where so many live without knowing You closely, for those who seek "something more" but don't know what that is. Help us to share with them the Good News that You love them, and have been drawing them to Yourself.

We thank You for the many churches where Your Word is faithfully preached and lived, and earnestly seek for the expansion of the visible church. We ask that You would strengthen Your people to stand firm but with grace, and that those wandering in darkness might see the changed lives of Your people.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, that we would be faithful servants in the work of the Kingdom. We pray for opportunities to serve both inside and outside the church, those who are in need of Your unfailing love and the sure hope of an eternal future.

We pray for the Selection Committee which meets today, as they seek Your wisdom, and work to do Your will in the search for a new minister. Grant them unity as they consider the processes available to us, and perseverance as the year progresses.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Jan, Diane and others affected by illness or injury. We especially lift up Joan Milne today as she is not able to be with us. Please strengthen her and enable her to rest well.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Douglas as he preaches today. We pray that we may properly imitate the Thessalonian church, learning from Paul's teaching and applying it to our 21st century circumstances.

In Jesus Precious Name we pray, Amen.